



The Garamut
"The message sender"

Ps Barry Reflections from 'The WORD'!

**For PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION &
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

**Bethel Global Missions
No.1. for 2nd February 2026**



SEEING CLEARLY WITHOUT DISTORTION

My theme text today is:

"I see men as trees walking"

Mark 8:22-25

22 And he cometh to Bethsaida; and they bring a blind man unto him, and besought him to touch him.

23 And he took the blind man by the hand, and led him out of the town; and when he had spit on his eyes, and put his hands upon him, he asked him if he saw ought.

*24 And he looked up, and said, ***I see men as trees, walking.****

25 After that he put his hands again upon his eyes and made him look up: and he was restored and saw every man clearly. KJV

I thought it's appropriate to begin this new year of 2026 with focusing on **SEEING THINGS CLEARLY WITHOUT FOGGY OR CLOUDED EYESIGHT AND SEEING THEM CLEARLY EVEN FROM A DISTANCE (ahead).**

SOME OF GOD'S PEOPLE ARE SHORT-SIGHTED AND CANNOT SEE FAR AHEAD.

In 2 Peter 1:9 it refers to those believers who lack certain Godly virtues qualities are near sighted or short-sighted (leading to Blindness) forgetting that they have already been forgiven of their past sins.

2 Peter 1:9 For he who lacks these things is shortsighted, even to blindness, and has forgotten that he was cleansed from his old sins. NKJV

GOD SEES ALL THINGS

2 Chronicles 16:9 For the eyes of the Lord run to and fro throughout the whole earth, to shew himself strong in the behalf of them whose heart is perfect toward him...." KJV

GOD SEES THE PRESENT AND THE FUTURE – NOW AND THOSE THINGS 'AFAR OFF'

Isaiah 46:9-10

9 "... I am God, and there is none like me.

10 Only I can tell you the future before it even happens. Everything I plan will come to pass, for I do whatever I wish. NLT

SO, HOW ARE WE APPROACHING THIS NEW YEAR?

- What are we envisaging this year to bring forth?
- **ARE OUR EXPECTATIONS AND ASPIRATIONS POSITIVE ONES?**
- Are we clear on what we are specifically asking God to do this year?
- Do we have clear plans and strategies for those things that we are expecting TO DO for God or are they a little blurred, foggy, clouded, like ***"seeing men as trees walking"***?

DO WE CLEARLY SEE AND UNDERSTAND WHAT IS HAPPENING IN THE WORLD AROUND US? E.G.

IN OUR NATION

- Are we fully aware of what is taking place in our nation, in society, communities, socially, economically, politically and morally?
- Are we conscious of what the prevailing trends and thinking patterns of most people in our nation are today?

IN THE CHURCH GENERAL

- What do we see happening in the church in our nation and in the nations (worldwide)?
- Are there things or trends happening that cause us to rejoice or conversely to be concerned about?
- Does there seem to be more emphasis on the “natural” rather than on the “Spiritual” the supernatural?
- What is it that we can do for our local church?
- Would making a greater commitment of our time and energy to the vision and mandate of our local church be a helpful factor?

IN OUR PERSONAL LIVES

- Are you clear as to what is personally happening in your life, or is it clouded, blurred, hazy, unclear and appearing to be something that it is not (*like seeing men as trees walking / distorted?*)
- Are we uncertain as to what our calling is and what we are supposed to BE and DO for God?
- Is this something that seems to be less certain for us than it has been in the past?
- Having a clearer picture (i.e the removal of the fogginess and haze) of who we are in Christ and our calling to serve God is a necessity essential for our lives.

IN OUR MARRIAGE – OUR FAMILY

- In the busyness of balancing ministry and family responsibilities, are we clearly seeing the dangers of failure to adequately address this matter of maintaining a healthy balance of healthy relationships with our spouses and children?
- Being overly occupied with service & ministry can cause us to have a blind spot in our vision or seeing exactly what is really happening in our family.
- Take some time out to regularly reflect and see.

IN OUR MINISTRY / SERVICE FOR CHRIST

- When vision becomes **uncomfortable**, then vision becomes expendable.
- All too often we see the abandonment of the vision that God has given us because it has become **too troublesome, difficult, painful and requiring sacrifice**.
- Additionally, when our vision is unpopular and different from the expectations of others, there is the temptation to lessen our efforts in continuing to press forward with that vision.
- In pursuing our God-given vision, we do encounter severe opposition and are sorely pressed by the tempter (Satan), **who then** presents the thought of an alternative to pursue in place of that godly vision.
- Is it possible that somehow, we might have shifted a little or moved away from the principles of **FAITH** and **TRUSTING God** that we once observed and lived by?
- Have we forgotten and become clouded as to the integral place that the miraculous power of God plays in us successfully bringing the unchurched to Christ?
- Is there a need for us to rediscover the importance of **passion and compassion** as an essential quality in our lives, enabling us through all circumstances and oppositions to continue reaching the lost?

A TOUCH FROM JESUS AGAIN

*Mark 8:25 Then Jesus placed his hands on the man's eyes **AGAIN**, and his eyes were opened. His sight was completely restored, and he could see everything clearly. NLT*

- Have we ever considered that all of us **might need another touch of Jesus** on our lives, enabling us to see all things clearly and even from a distance?
- My prayer is for this to happen to each one of us today, **NOW!**
- So let us join together in **asking Jesus to touch us again** and clear our minds, attitudes, enabling us to **WALK IN CONFIDENCE and ASSURANCE OF OUR CALLING**.
- **NO MORE** blurred and foggy vision!
- **NO MORE** seeing “*men as trees walking*”
- **SEEING EVERYTHING CLEARLY**
Amen – Ps Barry